

DEPART TRAVEL SERVICES

DEPART TRAVEL SERVICES · TUNISIA

TUNISIA

Offbeat, culinary & community travel — prepared for Rosetta Reizen

WHO WE ARE

Depart Travel Services is a licensed Tunisian Destination Management Company based in Djerba, in the deep south of the country. We design and operate journeys across the whole of Tunisia — from the Roman cities of the north to the dunes of the Grand Erg Oriental and the Berber ksour of the Dahar mountains.

We run our own insured vehicle fleet, work with ONTT-certified, English-speaking national tour leaders, and provide 24/7 in-country support. Our team works fluently in English and French. Whether the brief is a private FIT itinerary, a small escorted group, or a fully tailor-made commission, every booking is handled directly by the people on the ground who will make it happen.

WHY DEPART TRAVEL — FOR ROSETTA REIZEN

Theo, your business is built on the kind of travel Tunisia does exceptionally well but rarely sells: offbeat routing, genuine community contact, real food, and characterful local stays. That is precisely the corner of the market we have built our DMC around.

- **Offbeat over obvious.** We routinely route clients through the Dahar ksour, Chenini and Douiret, the mountain oases of Chebika, Tamerza and Midès, and a wild bivouac in the Grand Erg Oriental — not the package-coast circuit.
 - **Community-based tourism is built in, not bolted on.** Overnights in a restored troglodyte house, a Berber family home in Matmata, cooking with families, Berber music and storytelling at the desert camp, and direct fair payment to artisans and hosts.
 - **Culinary depth.** Cooking sessions with families, harissa and olive-oil producers, Andalusian Testour, Djerban fusion cuisine, and a vineyard tasting near Hammamet — a full dedicated culinary product, not a token meal.
 - **Accommodation that matches your clients' taste.** Around 95% locally-owned: boutique and heritage *dars*, oasis hotels such as Tamerza Palace, our Sahara desert camp, a troglodyte guesthouse, and island *dars* on Djerba.
 - **Built for the Dutch FIT and small-group market.** Guaranteed departures from just two participants, no compulsory single supplement, and fully flexible private and tailor-made formats — ideal for the FIT and small-group profile Rosetta Reizen serves.
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WHY TUNISIA FOR YOUR TRAVELLERS

Since this is your first visit, a quick orientation. Tunisia packs an extraordinary range into short driving distances: world-class Roman sites (Dougga, El Jem, Carthage, Sbeitla, Bulla Regia), the holy city of Kairouan, living Berber culture in the Dahar, real Sahara within a day of the coast, and the island of Djerba with its weavers, potters and one of the oldest synagogues in the world. It is safe, welcoming, easy to combine culture with adventure and food, and — crucially for a developing programme — still genuinely uncrowded off the main coast.

The 2 August 2027 total solar eclipse — a ready-made hook. The path of totality crosses North Africa, and southern Tunisia sits in prime, clear-sky desert eclipse country. With your 2027 eclipse tour already in motion, Tunisia is a natural pre- or post-extension: a few days of Berber ksour, Sahara bivouac and Djerba either side of totality, or a dedicated southern-desert eclipse-season product built around a dark-sky camp in the Grand Erg Oriental. We can pre-block desert camp capacity now and build a costed shell whenever you are ready.

RECOMMENDED FOR ROSETTA REIZEN

Tour	Duration	Why it fits you
Berber South & Sahara — Beyond the Map	8–9 days	Your sweet spot — offbeat ksour, Chenini/Douiret, Matmata, a wild Sahara bivouac and CBT stays.
Flavours of Tunisia	7–8 days	Cooking with families, harissa & olive producers, Andalusian Testour and Djerban cuisine.
Grand Tunisia Journey	12 days	The complete first-timer overview, north to Sahara to Djerba and coast.
Walking Tunisia — Coast, Oases & Berber Trails	8 days	Soft-adventure walking through oases and Berber trails for active FITs.
Roman Tunisia — Empires of the Sand	8 days	A focused archaeology product for culture-led clients.
Highlights of Tunisia	8 days	Compact best-of, including Sahara camp and a troglodyte night.

Berber South & Sahara — Beyond the Map

Overview. Eight to nine days through the part of Tunisia your clients will not find in a brochure: the fortified granaries (*ksour*) of the Dahar, the cliff-clinging Berber villages of Chenini and Douiret, the

troglodyte dwellings of Matmata, and a camel-borne bivouac under the stars in the Grand Erg Oriental. Community contact and authentic stays are the spine of the trip.

Key Information. Land-only, twin-share · guaranteed from 2 participants · private, small-group or tailor-made · no compulsory single supplement · ONTT-certified English-speaking tour leader · own insured fleet · 24/7 in-country support.

Highlights. Chenini & Douiret hilltop villages · Ksar Hadada & Dahar ksour · troglodyte overnight at Au Trait d'Union, Tijma · Berber family home in Matmata · camel trek & wild bivouac in the Grand Erg Oriental · Berber music & storytelling at the camp · Djerba weavers and Guellala pottery.

Day-by-Day Itinerary

Day 1: Arrival in Djerba

Welcome at Djerba airport and transfer to a locally-owned island *dar*. Time to settle in, with an orientation briefing from your tour leader over mint tea and a first taste of Djerban hospitality.



Accommodation: Dar Dhiafa, Djerba · *Meals:* Dinner.

Day 2: Djerba — weavers, potters and the medina

A day with Djerba's living crafts: the weavers' workshops, the pottery kilns of Guellala, the lanes of Houmt Souk, and the colourful open-air murals of Djerbahood. Every stop pays artisans and hosts directly.



Accommodation: Dar Dhiafa, Djerba · *Meals:* Breakfast, lunch.

Day 3: Into the Dahar — Ksar Hadada & the ksour

Cross to the mainland and climb into the Dahar mountains to explore the fortified Berber granaries, with Ksar Hadada among the finest. We walk the ksour with a local guide who grew up among them.



Accommodation: Restored guesthouse, Dahar · *Meals:* Breakfast, lunch, dinner.

Day 4: Chenini & Douiret

A full day among the cliff-clinging Berber villages of Chenini and Douiret — terraced houses, underground mosques and sweeping valley views. Lunch is shared with a local family.



Accommodation: Restored guesthouse, Dahar · *Meals:* Breakfast, lunch, dinner.

Day 5: Matmata — a Berber family home

We descend to Matmata to stay overnight in a troglodyte dwelling carved into the earth, hosted by a Berber family. Evening conversation, home cooking and a window into daily mountain life.



Accommodation: Berber family troglodyte home, Matmata · *Meals:* Breakfast, lunch, dinner.

Day 6: Into the Sahara — camel trek & wild bivouac

Transfer to the dune edge near Douz, then mount up for a camel trek into the Grand Erg Oriental to a wild bivouac. Camel encounters are welfare-compliant and always optional. Dinner around the fire under a vast desert sky.



Accommodation: Wild bivouac, Grand Erg Oriental · *Meals:* Breakfast, lunch, dinner.

Day 7: Desert dawn & Berber music

Sunrise over the dunes, a slow desert morning, and an evening of Berber music and storytelling around the campfire — the kind of unscripted, human moment your clients remember for years.



Accommodation: Sahara desert camp (Dunes Insolites) · *Meals:* Breakfast, lunch, dinner.

Day 8: Troglodyte night at Tijma

Leave the sand for the restored troglodyte house Au Trait d'Union at Tijma, a characterful CBT stay. A relaxed final day with time to absorb the journey before departure.



Accommodation: Au Trait d'Union, Tijma · *Meals:* Breakfast, dinner.

Day 9: Departure

Transfer to Djerba airport (or onward connection) for your flight home, with optional extensions to the eclipse-season desert product on request.



Accommodation: — · *Meals:* Breakfast.

Flavours of Tunisia — Culinary & Cultural

Overview. Seven to eight days following Tunisia through its kitchens and markets: cooking hands-on with families, meeting harissa and olive-oil producers, exploring the Andalusian heritage of Testour, and discovering the distinctive fusion cuisine of Djerba. A culture-first food journey for clients who travel to taste a place.

Key Information. Land-only, twin-share · guaranteed from 2 participants · private, small-group or tailor-made · no compulsory single supplement · ONTT-certified English-speaking tour leader · own insured fleet · 24/7 in-country support.

Highlights. Cooking with families · harissa & olive-oil producers · Andalusian Testour · Djerban fusion cuisine · Sidi Bou Saïd · Kairouan's makroudh · vineyard wine tasting near Hammamet · markets and family kitchens throughout.

Day-by-Day Itinerary

Day 1: Arrival in Tunis & Sidi Bou Saïd

Welcome at Tunis airport and transfer to a boutique *dar*. An easy first evening in the blue-and-white village of Sidi Bou Saïd, with a sunset *bambalouni* and mint tea overlooking the bay.



Accommodation: Boutique dar, Tunis · *Meals:* Dinner.

Day 2: Tunis medina — markets & a family kitchen

A morning through the medina's spice and produce souks, then a hands-on cooking session in a family kitchen: brik, slata mechouia and a tagine you sit down to share with your hosts.



Accommodation: Boutique dar, Tunis · *Meals:* Breakfast, lunch.

Day 3: Andalusian Testour & a vineyard near Hammamet

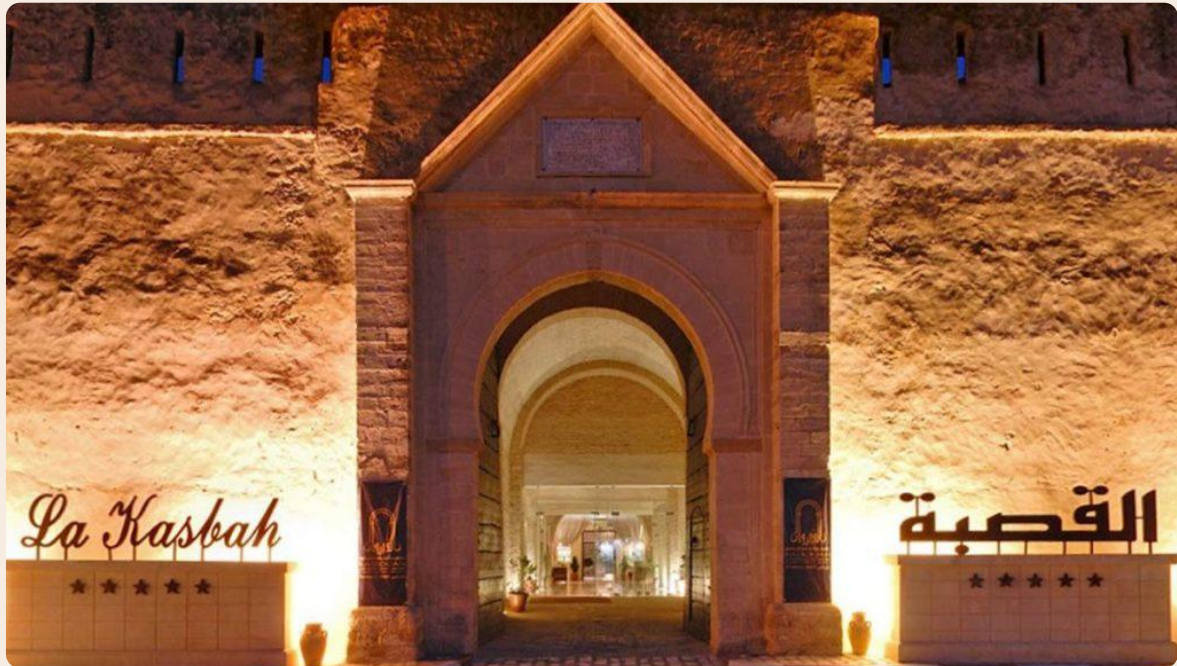
Drive to Testour to taste the Andalusian heritage baked into its breads and pastries, then on to a vineyard near Hammamet for a wine tasting and a walk around the kasbah.



Accommodation: Heritage dar, Hammamet · *Meals:* Breakfast, lunch, dinner.

Day 4: Olive oil & the road south to Kairouan

A visit to an olive-oil producer to follow the fruit from grove to press, then into Kairouan — Tunisia's holy city and home of the syrup-soaked makroudh, tasted fresh from the source.



Accommodation: Heritage dar, Kairouan · *Meals:* Breakfast, lunch.

Day 5: Harissa country & the southern oases

Meet a harissa producer to understand Tunisia's defining condiment from chilli to jar, then continue toward the oasis country with a stop among the palm groves and a relaxed oasis-side lunch.



Accommodation: Oasis hotel (Tamerza Palace) · *Meals:* Breakfast, lunch, dinner.

Day 6: To Djerba — the island table

Cross to Djerba, the most distinctive food culture in the country, where Berber, Jewish and Arab influences meet. An afternoon market walk sets up the evening's island cooking session.



Accommodation: Island dar (Dar Dhiafa) · *Meals:* Breakfast, dinner.

Day 7: Djerban fusion cuisine

A full day of Djerban cooking — the island's fish, octopus and date dishes — with a family who farm and fish what they cook. Time to wander Houmt Souk and Guellala before a farewell dinner.



Accommodation: Island dar (Dar Dhiafa) · *Meals:* Breakfast, lunch, dinner.

Day 8: Departure

A final island breakfast and transfer to Djerba airport, with optional extensions into the Berber south or the 2027 eclipse-season desert product on request.



Accommodation: — · Meals: Breakfast.

RESPONSIBLE TRAVEL

Responsible operation is structural to how we build trips, not a marketing line:

- Around **95% of accommodation is locally owned** — *dars*, oasis hotels, our desert camp and a troglodyte guesthouse.
- Around **90% of meals** are taken at locally-owned restaurants and family kitchens.
- **Fair, direct payment** to artisans and hosts on craft and CBT experiences.
- **ABTA-aligned animal welfare** — camel encounters are welfare-compliant and always optional.
- **Reusable water refills** to cut single-use plastic.
- **Indicative CO₂e per person per night** provided and ready to validate via eCollective.

PRICING

All figures below are **ILLUSTRATIVE** land-only, twin-share net rates and are confirmed at contracting. Rates scale with group size; there is **no compulsory single supplement**.

Product	Group / private	Illustrative net pp (EUR)
8-day tours (Berber South, Flavours, Roman, Highlights)	Larger group	from ~€931
8-day tours	2-pax private	up to ~€1,770
12-day Grand Tunisia Journey	Larger group	from ~€1,158
12-day Grand Tunisia Journey	2-pax private	up to ~€2,952

Send us any brief — FIT, private, small-group or fully tailor-made — and you will receive a **costed response within 72 hours**.

LET'S BUILD YOUR TUNISIA

Theo, it was a pleasure to host you on the fam trip. Here is how we turn it into product for Rosetta Reizen:

1. **Pick a lead product** — we suggest *Berber South & Sahara* and *Flavours of Tunisia* as your first two Tunisia lines.
2. **Send us a brief** — target pax, season, accommodation tier and any FIT customisations; we will return a costed shell within 72 hours.
3. **Scope the 2027 eclipse** — let us pre-block desert camp capacity and draft a pre/post or dedicated southern-desert eclipse extension around 2 August 2027.
4. **Contract & launch** — we finalise net rates and support you with imagery and copy for the Dutch market.

Depart Travel Services — licensed Tunisian DMC, Djerba

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🕒 A costed response within 72 hours — guaranteed.